

The lady in distress

Written by

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FADE IN

1. INT. AILEEN'S ROOM - DAY

AILEEN (21), a stereotypical pretty white girl with straight brown hair and brown eyes, in her pyjamas, is violently throwing clothes out of her wardrobe. The room is small but it is filled with different objects: shelves with books, toys, photos... There is a desk full of school material, makeup, a connected hair straightener and a laptop playing music. Next to it, there is a full-body length mirror. The morning sun is coming through a window, half-covered with curtains. There is a digital clock marking 8 A.M. The clock beeps.

AILEEN
There is NOTHING!

She continues to through clothes around. Then she starts to anxiously look around at the huge pile of clothes on the floor.

AILEEN (CONT'D)
AGH!

She notices herself hyperventilating and starts to slow down her breath. She sighs. Her eyes become watery. She breaks into tears and drops down to the floor. Her crying becomes loud. She starts to scratch her skin.

AILEEN (CONT'D)
Why?! Why?! Why?! Come on! Why now?

Aileen continues to aggressively scratch her skin until one of her arms bleeds. She cries even more and hides her head between her legs. A gold necklace hangs out of her neck. She notices it and holds onto it while swinging her body back and forth. As she calms down, she stares at the necklace. It is a small medal with the inscription of a flower. 'Vienna' by Billy Joel starts playing. She takes a deep breath, dries her tears and scans around the room. She reaches for a white linen long sleeve shirt. Then she stands up and finds a denim mini-skirt. She starts to dress up.

CUT TO:

2. EXT. UNIVERSITY CAMPUS - DAY. SUNNY.

Aileen walks through a park while carrying a big purse.

KATYA (21), a stylish black girl, happily runs towards her.

KATYA

Hey, girl! You won't believe the
gorgeous dress my step-dad gifted
me for graduation. Look!

Katya takes out a high fashion magazine out of her purse and
searches through the pages. She finds the page and shows it
to Aileen.

KATYA (CONT'D)

Vivienne. Westwood. Archive.
Impressive, don't you think?

Aileen gives Katya a bothered look.

AILEEN

Wow, yes, Katya, very impressive...
Who did he bribe for that?
(rolls her eyes)

KATYA

Come on, Aileen, don't be like
that. He's a hard-working man! And
well... A little contact here...
Another contact there...
(giggles)

Aileen and Katya share an innocent laugh. Aileen looks at the
time on her phone.

KATYA (CONT'D)

I know, we should hurry up.

3. INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

Small white classroom. Around 30 students are sitting,
talking in groups. The MS. HOOVER (50) arrives late,
exhausted.

MS. HOOVER

(Sighs)
Sorry, guys. There was a fire in a
house near Moxie's theater and they
cut the road to come here.

AILEEN

Wait, WHAT? Sorry, I just need a...

Aileen runs out of class to make a phone call. She is
hyperventilating. Her skin is itchy again. Finally, her
mother answers. She is coughing and sounds stressed.

MOM

Aileen... My dear...
(sobs)